

Bhojpuri language

Bhojpuri (IPA: /ˌboʊdʒˈpʊəri/^[7] Devanagari: भोजपुरी[ⓘ], Kaithi: भोजपुरी, (IPA: [bʰoːdʒpʊɾiː]) is an Indo-Aryan language native to the Bhojpur-Purvanchal region of India and the Terai region of Nepal.^[8] It is chiefly spoken in eastern Uttar Pradesh, western Bihar, and northwestern Jharkhand in India, as well as western Madhesh and eastern Lumbini in Nepal. According to the 2011 Census of India, it is spoken by approximately 50.5 million people.^[9]

It is also a minority language in Fiji, Mauritius, Suriname and historically primarily in the Natal province of South Africa.^{[10][11]} Fiji Hindi, an official language of Fiji, is a dialect of Bhojpuri spoken by the Indo-Fijians. Caribbean Hindustani is spoken by the Indo-Caribbean people in Guyana, Suriname, Jamaica and Trinidad and Tobago.^[12] In Mauritius, it is recognised by the government and taught in university as well.^[13]

Bhojpuri language is listed as potentially vulnerable in the UNESCO World Atlas of Languages.^[14]

Name

The oldest presence of the word "Bhojpuri" is found as *Bodjpooria* in 1789 in the translator's preface of a book titled *A Translation of the Sëir Mutaqherin*, which is a translation of a Persian book written in 1780 by Ghulam Hussain Khan.^[15] The paragraph in which reads:

"Don't make so much noise" said of them in his Bhojpooria idiom, "we go to-day with the Frenghees, but we all are servant to Chëyt Singh, and may come back tomorrow with

Bhojpuri

भोजपुरी · भोजपुरी

भोजपुरी

The word "Bhojpuri" in the Devanagari script

Native to	India and Nepal
Region	Bhojpur-Purvanchal
Ethnicity	Bhojpuriya
Native speakers	52.2 million, partial count (2011 census) ^{[1][2]} (additional speakers counted under Hindi)
Language family	Indo-European - Indo-Iranian - Indo-Aryan - Eastern - Bihari Bhojpuri
Early forms	Magadhi Prakrit - Magadhan Apabhramśa - Abahattha
Dialects	Northern Standard Bhojpuri - Western Standard Bhojpuri - Southern Standard Bhojpuri - Domra - Musahari - Mauritian Bhojpuri^[3] - South African Bhojpuri (Naitali)^[4]

him and then question will not be about your roots, but about your wives and daughters."

—A Translation of the Sëir Mutaqherin,
Translator's Preface

The word *Bhojpuri* is derived from Bhojpur. After the conquest of Chero and Ujjainiya Rajputs in 12th century, who were the descendants of Raja Bhoj from Ujjain, Malwa, Madhya Pradesh captured Shahabad and named their capital Bhojpur (City of Raja Bhoj).^[16] The seat of their government was Bhojpur village which was near Dumraon in Buxar. Two villages named Chhotka Bhojpur and Barka Bhojpur still exist in Buxar, where the ruins of their Navratna Fortress can still be seen. Slowly the word *Bhojpur* became the synonyms of the Shahabad or Arrah region (Today's Bhojpur district, Buxar, Kaimur and Rohtas)^[17] and the adjective *Bhojpuri* or *Bhojpuriya* extended to mean the language or people of Bhojpur and even beyond it. Apart from *Bhojpuri* in the Eastern UP and Western Bihar, there were other names also for the language and people, at different places, the Bhojpuriya in Mughal armies were used to called *Buxariya*.^[18] In Bengal, they called *Paschhimas* (Westerners) and Bhojpuri people also called them *Deshwali* or *Khotta*, in upper provinces like Oudh they called *Purabiya*. Besides these, *Banarasi*, *Chhaprahiya*, and *Bangarahi* has also used for the language and People. Rahul Sankrityayan has suggested two names for it i.e. *Mallika* or *Malli* (due to ancient tribe of Malla) and *Kashiki* (due to ancient Kashi).^[19] The Girmityas who were taken to British colonies called it simply *Hindustani* or *Hindi* and it became *Fiji Hindi* in Fiji and *Caribbean Hindustani* in the Caribbean region.^[20] Similarly, in South Africa, while often locally referred to by speakers as 'Hindustani', the variety brought by indentured labourers who embarked at Calcutta was also known as '**Kalkatia**'.^[10]

	<u>Nagpuri</u> <u>Caribbean Hindustani</u> (incl. <u>Sarnami Hindustani</u>)
Writing system	<u>Devanagari</u> <u>Kaithi</u> (historical)
Official status	
Official language in	 <u>Fiji</u> (as <u>Fiji Hindi</u>)  <u>Nepal</u>
Recognised minority language in	 <u>India</u> <u>Jharkhand</u>^[5]  <u>Mauritius</u>  <u>South Africa</u> (as <u>Naitali Bhojpuri</u>)
Regulated by	<u>India</u> <u>Bihar</u> (<u>Bhojpuri Academy</u>)^[6] <u>Delhi</u> (<u>Maithili-Bhojpuri Academy</u>, <u>Delhi</u>) <u>Madhya Pradesh</u> (<u>Bhojpuri Sahitya Academy</u>)
Language codes	
ISO 639-2	<u>bho</u> (https://www.iso.org/standards/iso639-2/php/langcodes_name.php?code_ID=55)
ISO 639-3	<u>bho</u>
Glottolog	<u>bhoj1244</u> (https://glottolog.org/resource/languoid/id/bhoj1244)
Linguasphere	<u>59-AAF-sa</u> (http://www.hortensj-garden.org/g/index.php?tnc=1&tr=1sr&nid=59-AAF-sa)

History

Bhojpuri is a descendant of Magadhi Prakrit^[21] which started taking shape during the reign of the Vardhana dynasty. Bāṇabhaṭṭa, in his Harshacharita has mentioned two poets named Isānchandra and Benibhārata who used to write in local language instead of Prakrit and Sanskrit.^{[22][23]}



A speaker of Bhojpuri

Initial period (700–1100 A.D.)

Some scholar enthusiasts like to trace the literary history of Bhojpuri from Siddha Sahitya, as early as the 8th century A.D.^{[24][25]}. But it's not widely accepted.^[26]

1100–1400 A.D.

Between the 11th and 14th centuries A.D., much Bhojpuri folklore such as Lorikayan, Sorathi Birjabh, Vijaymal, Gopichand, Raja Bharthariar came into existence.^[27] Alongside these, the Nath Saint composed literature in Bhojpuri. In this period, the Bhojpuri language altered and its regional boundaries were established.^[28]

Period of saints (1400–1700 A.D.)

In this era, saints from different sects such as Kabir, Dharni Das, Kina Ram and Dariya Saheb used Bhojpuri as their language of discourse. In the same period Arabic and Persian words came into Bhojpuri. Folk songs are also said to have been composed in this era.^[29]

Early research period (1700–1900 A.D.)

A document of Horil Siha, the King of Bhojpur, dated 1728, script: Kaithi

Kaithi

स्वोस्ति स्म रिपु राज दैत्य नाराएनेत्य-आदि विविध विरदवली विराजमान मनोनत श्री माहाराजाधिराज राजा श्री-जिव देव देवानाम् सदा समर बिजैना। आगे सुवंस पांड़े परा-आग के उपरोहित पाछिल राजन्ह के उपरोहित हऊही से हमहु आपन उपरोहित कईल। जे केउ परा-अग माह आवे से सुवंस पांड़े के माने, उजेन नाव ॥ ११३६ साल मोकाम दावा धुस समत १७८५ समै नाम बैसाख सुदि तिरोदसि रोज बुध। प्रगने भोजपुर गोतर सवनक मुल उजेन जाति पावार

सुवंस जे पाछिला राजन्ह के उपरोहित हऊही से हमहु कईल आपन उपरोहित

Devnagari

स्वोस्ति स्म रिपु राज दैत्य नाराएनेत्य-आदि विविध विरदवली विराजमान मनोनत श्री माहाराजाधिराज राजा श्री-जिव देव देवानाम् सदा समर बिजैना। आगे सुवंस पांड़े परा-आग के उपरोहित पाछिल राजन्ह के उपरोहित हऊही से हमहु आपन उपरोहित कईल। जे केउ परा-अग माह आवे से सुवंस पांड़े के माने, उजेन नाव ॥ ११३६ साल मोकाम दावा धुस समत १७८५ समै नाम बैसाख सुदि तिरोदसि रोज बुध। प्रगने भोजपुर गोतर सवनक मुल उजेन जाति पावार

सुवंस जे पाछिला राजन्ह के उपरोहित हऊही से हमहु कईल अपन उपरोहित

English Translation

The statement is that: Suvansa pande of Prayag is the priest of the past Rājās, so I also made him my priest. Whosoever among the Ujjen (Rajputs) comes to Prayag should have regard for him. Year 1136 place Dawa (The old place of the Rajas of Bhojpur, now a village) samat 1785 (A.D. 1728) date 13th of the bright part of Baisakha, Wednesday Paragana Bhojpur, Gotra Sawanak, origin Ujen, caste Pawara.

Suvans, who is the priest of the past Rājās, him I also made my priest.

—Horil Siha (King of Bhojpur), *Origin and Development of Bhojpuri*, pp 218-219

In this period the British established themselves as the colonial power in India, and scholars from Britain conducted the first academic study of Bhojpuri. Bhojpuri folk literature was researched, and the Bhojpuri region was mapped for the first time. In this period Bhojpuri became an international language.^[30] Between 1838 and 1917 labourers from the Bhojpuri region were taken to British Colonies like Fiji, Mauritius, Guyana, Trinidad and Tobago and South Africa, as well as the Dutch colony of Suriname as plantation workers. Linguistic analysis of the South African context indicates that while the majority of migrants arriving via Calcutta (1860-1911) originated from Bhojpuri-speaking areas of Bihar and eastern Uttar Pradesh, there was also a substantial presence of speakers from Awadhi-speaking regions. This resulted in a process of language coalescence and the formation of a distinct **koiné variety** of Bhojpuri in South Africa, influenced by contact between these related dialects.^[10] Music genres based on Bhojpuri folk music such as Chutney music, Baithak Gana, Geet Gawanai and Lok Geet arose in those countries.^{[31][32]} In the Caribbean, particularly Trinidad, the evolution from Bhojpuri folk traditions performed at weddings led to the development of Chutney music as a distinct genre, often incorporating English lyrics and Soca rhythms alongside Bhojpuri elements.^[33]

British scholars like Buchanan, Beames and George Abraham Grierson studied the language in details. Beames published the grammar of Bhojpuri for the first time in 1868. Grierson compiled and published the folksongs of Bhojpuri in 1884. He published the folklore of Bhojpuri and also made the dictionaries in Bhojpuri. He also conducted the Linguistic Survey of India.^[35] In his work, Grierson characterised Bhojpuri as "*a practical language of an energetic race*"^[36]



Statue named Baba en Mai commemorating the arrival of first Indian couple in Suriname^[34]

Present period (1900–present)

In the 19th century, notable works like Devakshara Charita, Badmash Darpan were published. In the 20th century, Bhikhari Thakur contributed significantly to Bhojpuri literature and theatre with his notable plays like Bidesiya, Beti Bechwa, Gabarghichor and novels like *Bindia* and *Phulsunghi* were published. In 1962, the first Bhojpuri film, *Ganga Maiyya Tohe Piyari Chadhaibo* was released and became the founding stone of the Bhojpuri film industry.

Bhojpuri is listed as a potentially vulnerable language in the UNESCO world atlas of languages due to the influence of Hindi.^[14] Words like *Bujhā* are being replaced by Hindi words like *Samjhā*.^[37]

Geographic distribution

The Bhojpuri-speaking region covers the area of 73,000 square kilometres approximately in India and Nepal^[38] and borders the Awadhi-speaking region to the west, the Nepali-speaking region to the north, the Magahi and Bajjika-speaking regions to the east and the Chhattisgarhi and Bagheli-speaking regions to the south.^[8] In Nepal, Bhojpuri is a major language in south-western districts bordering Bihar and Uttar Pradesh.^[39] There are a number of Bhojpuri-speaking Muslims that are part of the Muhajir community in Pakistan, as well as in Bangladesh, where they are referred to as Stranded Pakistanis due to them speaking Bhojpuri and Urdu as their native tongue and not Bengali as most Bangladeshis do. They migrated to Bangladesh there during the Partition of India when the area was part of East Pakistan, before gaining independence as Bangladesh.

Bhojpuri is spoken by descendants of indentured labourers brought in the 19th and early 20th centuries for work in plantations in British colonies. These Bhojpuri speakers live in Mauritius, Fiji, South Africa, Trinidad and Tobago, Guyana, Suriname, Jamaica, and other parts of the Caribbean.^{[10][39][40]} In South Africa, speakers were historically concentrated in the Natal province. However, the language experienced significant decline throughout the 20th century, undergoing language shift towards English, with intergenerational transmission largely ceasing by the late 1900s. This South African variety also experienced language contact effects from English, Zulu, and Fanagalo.^[10] In Mauritius, music is considered a primary vehicle for maintaining the language, with songs often reflecting adaptation to new environments and mixing Bhojpuri with Mauritian Creole. In Trinidad and Tobago, while Caribbean Hindustani remains, popular music forms like Chutney often feature significant English admixture, reflecting linguistic creolisation, as exemplified by artists like Sundar Popo.^[33]



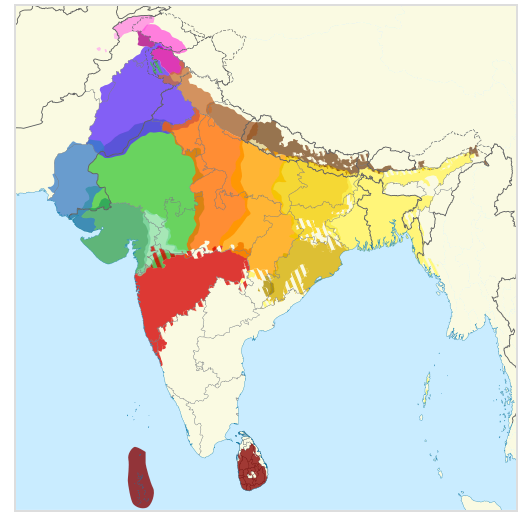
Arrival of Bhojpuri speaking people in Trinidad and Tobago

Classification

Bhojpuri is an Indo-European language and belongs to the Eastern Indo-Aryan group of the Indo-Aryan languages. The Magahi and Maithili languages of Eastern Indo-Aryan group are closest living relatives of Bhojpuri. Odia, Bengali and Assamese are also closely related.^{[41][42]} Bhojpuri along with Magahi and Maithili, are grouped together as the Bihari languages. Together with the other branches of Eastern Indo-Aryan, the Bihari languages are considered to be direct descendants of the Magadhi Prakrit.

Bhojpuri is classified as an Eastern Indo-Aryan Language because it has similar inflexion system to the other languages of the same family such as Bengali, Maithili and Odia. For example, the pronunciation of the vowel *a* is broad in Eastern Indo-Aryan languages, and sounds like *o* in Bengali,

on moving westwards it becomes less broad but still can be differentiated from the sharp cut *a* in Middle Indo-Aryan. In Bhojpuri, the clear cut *a* and the drawled *a*, which sounds like *aw* in the word *awl* are present and the contrast between the two gives a different tone to the language.^[43] This drawled *a* is represented by Avagraha (ऽ), for instance, the word *dekh'la*, you see, is written as देखलऽ.^[44] Other property of Eastern Indo Aryan languages is that the adjectives does not change with the noun. For instance, *moīā* is the feminine form of *moī* in Hindi. However, as with Bengali, in Bhojpuri, only *moī* is used. The past and future tense in Bhojpuri is formed in same way as other Eastern Indo-Aryan Languages, by adding a suffix stating from *-la* and *-ba* respectively to the verb. Form example, *I shall See*, in Bengali is *dekh-bo* and in Bhojpuri is *dekh-ab*.^[45]



Major Indo-Aryan languages of South Asia; Eastern Indo-Aryan languages in shades of yellow

Some scholars has also divided the East Indo Aryan or *Magadhan* languages in to three sub-groups viz. Western, Central and Eastern. Bengali, Assamese, Odia belongs to Eastern Magadhan, Maithili and Magahi to Central and Bhojpuri to western.^{[46][47][48][49]} Bhojpuri is classified as Western Magadhan because it has some properties which are peculiar to itself and are not present in other Magadhan Languages. Some striking differences are:^[45]

- *raūrā* or *raūwā* as an honorific pronoun for second person along with the *apne* form is used Bhojpuri. *apne* form is their in other Magadhan Languages but *raūwā* is totally absent.
- Verb substantive in other Magadhan language is of *-acch* for but Bhojpuri has *-baṭe* and *hawe*.^{[50][51]}
- The simple present is made by Bhojpuri by adding a suffix starting from *-la* with the verb, but this is totally absent in the other languages of Magadhan group. Hence, *he sees*, is *dēkhe-lā* in Bhojpuri but in but *dekhai-chhi* in Maithili and *dekhechhi* in Bengali.

Dialects

Bhojpuri has several dialects: Southern Standard Bhojpuri, Northern Standard Bhojpuri, Western Standard Bhojpuri,^[52] and Nagpuria Bhojpuri.^{[53][39]}

Southern Standard Bhojpuri is prevalent in the Shahabad district (Buxar, Bhojpur, Rohtas, and Kaimur districts) and the Saran region (Saran, Siwan and Gopalganj districts) in Bihar, the eastern Azamgarh (Ballia and eastern Mau districts) and Varanasi (eastern part of Ghazipur district) regions in Uttar Pradesh, and in the Palamu division (Palamu and Garhwa districts) in Jharkhand. The dialect is also known as *Kharwari*.

Northern Bhojpuri is common in the western Tirhut division (east and west Champanan and in Muzaffarpur district) in Bihar, and Gorakhpur division (Deoria, Kushinagar, Gorakhpur, and Maharajganj districts) and Basti division (Sidharthanagar, and Sant Kabir Nagar districts) in Uttar Pradesh. It is also spoken in Nepal.^[54]

Western Bhojpuri is prevalent in the areas of Varanasi (Varanasi, Chandauli, eastern Jaunpur, and the western part of Ghazipur district), Azamgarh (Azamgarh district, western part of Mau district) and Mirzapur (Chunar of eastern Mirzapur and Sonbhadra districts) divisions in Uttar Pradesh.^[55] Banarasi is a local name for Bhojpuri, named after Banaras.

Nagpuria Bhojpuri is the southernmost popular dialect, found in the Chota Nagpur Plateau of Jharkhand, particularly parts of Palamu, South Chotanagpur and Kolhan divisions. It is sometimes referred to as *Sadari*.^{[56][57]}

A more specific classification recognises the dialects of Bhojpuri as Bhojpuri Domra, Madhesi, Musahari, Northern Standard Bhojpuri (Basti, Gorakhpuri, Sarawaria), Southern Standard Bhojpuri (Kharwari), Western Standard Bhojpuri (Benarsi, Purbi) and Nagpuriya Bhojpuri.

Mauritian Bhojpuri

Bhojpuri is a major language spoken by Indo-Mauritians, as the majority of the nearly 450,000 indentured labourers who arrived in Mauritius between 1834 and the early 1900s were Bhojpuri speakers who did not return to India. The speech that evolved in Mauritius is not based on a single dialect, but is rather a blend of several varieties of Indian Bhojpuri.^[58]

Over time, Mauritian Bhojpuri has undergone grammatical simplification when compared to its Indian counterpart. The most notable change is in the system of personal pronouns and honorifics. The multiple levels of honorifics (e.g., formal *ap*, informal *tu*) found in Indian Bhojpuri have been reduced, with Mauritian Bhojpuri primarily using a single form, *tou*, for "you". Similarly, the second and third-person plural pronouns have been simplified.^[58]

In present Mauritius, the language exists in a complex relationship with Mauritian Creole and Hindi. There is a degree of mutual intelligibility with Hindi, partly due to the teaching of Hindi in schools and access to Hindi-language television. Mauritian Bhojpuri has also been influenced by Mauritian Creole, particularly in its sentence structure and through lexical borrowing, with younger and more urban speakers tending to use more Creole words. The influence is bidirectional; it has been documented that Mauritian Creole has borrowed more than 300 words from Indo-Aryan languages, the majority of which are likely from Bhojpuri.^[58]

Phonology

Vowels^{[59][60]}

	<u>Front</u>	<u>Central</u>	<u>Back</u>
<u>Close</u>	<u>i</u> <u>ɪ</u>		<u>u</u>
<u>Close-mid</u>	<u>e</u>		<u>o</u>
<u>Mid</u>		<u>ə</u>	
<u>Open-mid</u>	<u>ɛ</u>		<u>ɔ</u>
<u>Open</u>	<u>æ</u>	<u>a</u>	

Consonants^[59]

		<u>Labial</u>	<u>(Denti-) Alveolar</u>	<u>Retroflex</u>	<u>(Alveolo-) palatal</u>	<u>Velar</u>	<u>Glottal</u>
<u>Nasal</u>		<u>m</u>	<u>n</u>	<u>ɳ</u>	<u>ɲ</u>	<u>ŋ</u>	
<u>Stop/ Affricate</u>	<u>voiceless</u>	<u>p</u>	<u>t̪</u>	<u>ʈ</u>	<u>tɕ</u>	<u>k</u>	
	<u>voiced</u>	<u>b</u>	<u>d̪</u>	<u>ɖ</u>	<u>dʒ</u>	<u>g</u>	
	<u>aspirated</u>	<u>pʰ</u>	<u>t̪ʰ</u>	<u>ʈʰ</u>	<u>tɕʰ</u>	<u>kʰ</u>	
	<u>breathy voiced</u>	<u>bʱ</u>	<u>d̪ʱ</u>	<u>ɖʱ</u>	<u>dʒʱ</u>	<u>gʱ</u>	
<u>Fricative</u>			<u>s</u>				<u>h</u>
<u>Rhotic</u>	<u>plain</u>		<u>ɾ</u>	<u>ɽ</u>			
	<u>breathy</u>		<u>ɾʱ</u>	<u>ɽʱ</u>			
<u>Approximant</u>		<u>w ~ ʋ</u>	<u>l</u>		<u>j</u>		

Among the seven languages which are sociolinguistically often counted as Hindi dialects (Haryanvi, Braj, Awadhi, Bhojpuri, Bundeli, Bagheli, and Kannauji),^[61] Bhojpuri has the most allophonic variations in vowels.^[62]

Bhojpuri has 6 vowel phonemes.^[21] The higher vowels are relatively tense, and the lower vowels are relatively lax. The language has 31 consonant phonemes and 34 contoids (6 bilabial, 4 apico-dental, 5 apico-alveolar, 7 retroflex, 6 alveo-palatal, 5 dorso-velar, and 1 glottal).^[59]

Linguist Robert L. Trammell published the phonology of Northern Standard Bhojpuri in 1971.^{[59][21]} According to him, the syllable system is peak type: every syllable has the vowel phoneme as the highest point of sonority. Codas may consist of one, two, or three consonants. Vowels occur as simple peaks or as peak nuclei in diphthongs. The intonation system involves 4 pitch levels and 3 terminal contours.^{[59][63]}

Word-stress in Bhojpuri is phonemic, meaning the placement of stress can change the meaning of a word. For example, the noun सौटा /'sota/ ('a short stick') is distinguished from the verb सौटा /so'ta/ ('to be slim') solely by the shift in stress. Additionally, it contains a series of devoicing aspirate sonorants (such as म्ह /mʰ/, ढ्ह /nʰ/) that function as independent phonemes, distinct from their unaspirated counterparts (like /m/ and /n/).^[64]

Grammar

Linguistically, Bhojpuri is an inflecting and almost entirely suffixing language. Nouns are inflected for case, number, and gender, while verbs are inflected for tense, aspect, mood, and person-number-gender agreement. A notable feature is its system of verbal honorifics, which marks politeness towards the subject directly in the verb form. Syntactically, Bhojpuri is a Subject-Object-Verb (SOV) language, though it allows for considerable free word-order.^[9] Unlike Hindi, it uses a nominative-accusative case system, does not have an oblique case.^[9]

According to George Abraham Grierson, the grammar of Bhojpuri is simpler than other languages of the same family.^[45] Nouns in Bhojpuri have three forms: short, long and redundant. The adjectives of nouns do not change with genders. Plurals are made by adding either the suffix *-na* or *ni* with the nouns or adding the multitudes such as *sabh* (all) or *lōg* (people).

Examples:^[45]

Definition	Singular Form	Plural Form
House	ghar	gharan
Horse	ghoṛā	ghoṛan
Boy	laiṁkā	laiṁkan/laiṁka sabh
King	rājā	rājā lōg

Except few instances the Verb forms of Bhojpuri depend only on the subject and the object has no effect on it. Unlike other Eastern Indo-Aryan languages, Bhojpuri has a different verb form for the present tense, which corresponds to the Future forms of Nepali. It is formed by adding the suffix *-lā* to the present subjunctive. Therefore, for the verb *to see* the Bhojpuri verb is *dekhe* and the present form is *dhekhelā*, which is peculiar to itself and is not found in other languages of the same family like Magahi (dekhaṁt haṁ), Maithili (dekhaṁt achi) and Bengali (dekhechī). The Verbs forms of second person singular (dekh'be; you will see) is considered vulgar in Bhojpuri, plural form (*dekhab'*) is used in general. When it is desired to show respect the first person singular form (*dekhab*; I will see) is used instead of second person plural (*dekhab'*). To show plural number the suffix *-sa'* or *-ja* is also used with the 2nd and third person forms, thus *dekhe-la'-sa* is *they see*. The present perfect form is made by adding *ha'* to the past form. Thus, *ham dekh'li* (I saw) is the past form and its present perfect form is *ham dekh'li ha'* (I have seen). Past perfect in regular verbs are made by adding the suffix *-al* to the verb (dekh - dekh'al), but in some cases it has irregular forms like *kar* (*kail*), *mar* (*mual*) etc.^[45]

Numerals of Bhojpuri take the classifier *gō* and *thō*, which emphasises the countability and totality both. To show inclusiveness and exclusiveness, Bhojpuri used the suffixes *-o* and *-e* as in *ham āmo khāib* (I will eat mangoes too) verses *ham āme khāib* (I will eat only mangoes). These suffixes can be added to any lexical category such as numerals, adjectives etc.^[65]

The auxiliaries in Bhojpuri are formed on five bases viz. *ha*, *ho*, *hokh*, *bāṭ*, *rah*. These also act as the Copula. The *bāṭ* form provides for the tenses and the *hokh* or *ho* form provides for the modes, where as *rah* is the past of other three.^[38]

Writing system

Bhojpuri was historically written in Kaithi script,^[8] but since 1894 Devanagari has served as the primary script. Kaithi has variants as the locality changes, the three classified variants are Tirhuti, Magahi and Bhojpuri variants. The Bhojpuri variant is used for writing Bhojpuri.^[45] Kaithi is now rarely used for Bhojpuri.

Kaithi script was used for administrative purposes in the Mughal era for writing Bhojpuri, Awadhi, Maithili, Magahi, and Hindustani from at least the 16th century up to the first decade of the 20th century. Government gazetteers report that Kaithi was used in a few districts of Bihar throughout the 1960s. Bhojpuri residents of India who moved to British colonies in Africa, the Indian Ocean, and the Caribbean in the 19th and early 20th centuries used both Kaithi and Devanagari scripts.^[10]

By 1894 both Kaithi and Devanagari became common scripts to write official texts in Bihar. At present almost all Bhojpuri texts are written in Devanagari, even in islands outside of India where Bhojpuri is spoken. In Mauritius, Kaithi script was historically considered informal, and Devanagari was sometimes spelled as *Devanagri*. In modern Mauritius, the major script is Devanagari.^[66]

Politeness

Bhojpuri syntax and vocabulary reflects a three-tier system of politeness. Any verb can be conjugated through these tiers. The verb *to come* in Bhojpuri is *aail* and the verb *to speak* is *bolal*. The imperatives *come!* and *speak!* can be conjugated in five ways, each marking subtle variation in politeness and propriety. These permutations exclude a host of auxiliary verbs and expressions, which can be added to verbs to add another degree of subtle variation. For extremely polite or formal situations, the pronoun is generally omitted.

Literary	[teh] āō	[teh] bōl
Casual and intimate	[tu] āō	[tu] bōl
Polite and intimate	[tu] āv'	[tu] bōl'
Formal yet intimate	[rau'ā] āīñ	[rau'ā] bōlīñ
Polite and formal	[āpne] āīñ	[āpne] bōlīñ
Extremely formal	āwal jā'e	bōlal jā'e

Similarly, adjectives are marked for politeness and formality. The adjective *your* has several forms with different tones of politeness: *tum* (casual and intimate), "tōhār" (polite and intimate), "t'hār" (formal yet intimate), *rā'ur* (polite and formal) and *āpke* (extremely formal). Although there are many tiers of politeness, Bhojpuri speakers mainly use the form *tu* to address a younger individual and *raua* for an individual who is older, or holds a higher position in workplace situations.

एक बहनी के दू देठा १८९१। सो में से खोठका अपने बाप से कहलस को
ए बाप हमने बय्यानी के जवन माँ बसबाव हो जवन हम के दा, एही पर बय्या
हूँला देठन के आपन बन बाँठा देहलस। वहुन दिन ना बोगे पावठ को खोठका देठा
कुठ आपन बन वठोत के कठोनी दू देठ के निकठ ११९० की आपन बन ब्याव
याँ में उठ्ठा पुठ्ठा ५००५। जव कुठ सोकर बन मोता ११९० तव मोह देठ में
वहुन काँ पठ्ठ, को उठाना के मोहगाज होवे ०१०। तव उ जा के मोह देठ के
एक सहा के १९५१५ के पाच पठ्ठयठ। उ सहेनो को के अपने घेर में खुन ब्यावे
के बाबो मेज देहलस। सोकर ६ दसा हो ११९० को जवन सुभितथा पुषी ब्याव
१९०१ कही जो को के भिठत तो उ सोही से आपन देठ पुषो से ११५५ ठेकिन १९०
वा को के नेव देव १९०। जव सो के येव ११९० तो उ अपने मन में कहलस को
नेवना लोकतहा मजदुतहा हमने बाप के बाँठ जेकरे बाए के वहुन हव बाँठक
वय जाठा सो हम गुबन मय हरे। हम अब अपने बाप किहा जाव को कहव को
ए बाप हम गोहने आँठो को दएठ के पाप करठो, एह ठाएक वरयो को बन. हम के
नेव गोहान देठा कहै। अपने लोकतहा मजदुतहा में से हम के खुह के १९५५।
१९६ के उ उठठ को अपने बाप किहा ११९०। जव दूने १९० तवे सोकर बाप को के
देवठस। को के दवह ११९०, ६०५ के ११९०, कोकरे ओठ ०१० को को के खुनठस। तव
देठोषा अपने बाप से कहलस को ए बाप हम गोहने हजुत को दएठ के पाप
करठो, बन गोहान देठा कहावे ठाएक नश्यो। ठेकिन बय्या अपने लोकन से कहलस
को जवन स्या से स्या कपडा हो जवन ठिशा के सोन के पहनावन जा को उन
के हाव में कपुठो को पैर में गुना पहनावा को सब केहु बाबा ब्याव जाइ को
पुषो करो, काहे से को ६ हमान देठा मने के बैन जोषठ है, हेराए के बैन
भिठठ है। एही पर सब केहु पुषो जने ०१०१॥

Bhojpuri story written in Kaithi script by Babu Rama Smaran Lal in 1898



Signboard at Purbi Gumti Arrah with "Lock no. 11" written on the board in Bhojpuri using Kaithi Script (on the left side), Persian script (on the right side) and Roman script (above).

Status

Greater official recognition of Bhojpuri, such as by inclusion in the Eighth Schedule to the Constitution of India, has been demanded.^[67] In 2018, Bhojpuri was given second-language status in Jharkhand state of India.^[68]

Bhojpuri is taught in matriculation and at the higher secondary level in the Bihar School Education Board and the Board of High School and Intermediate Education Uttar Pradesh. It is also taught in various universities in India, such as Veer Kunwar Singh University,^[69] Banaras Hindu University,^[70] Nalanda Open University,^[71] and Dr. Shakuntala Misra National Rehabilitation University.^[72]

In the digital and technology spheres, Bhojpuri was long considered a "low-resource language" due to a scarcity of standardised digital data and advanced computational tools. Early academic efforts, such as doctoral research at Jawaharlal Nehru University in 2018, focused on creating the first large-scale digital corpora (text collections) and experimental machine translation systems to begin addressing this gap.^[9]

A major milestone in the language's digital presence occurred in May 2022, when Google Translate officially added Bhojpuri to its platform. This significantly improved the language's accessibility and utility for millions of speakers globally. Despite this progress, challenges remain in developing more advanced NLP applications due to wide dialectal variations and the lack of a single, universally adopted standard for writing the language.^[73]

Sociolinguistic Context

Bilingualism and Code-Switching

Due to the prevalence of Hindi as the formal language of education and media, a majority of Bhojpuri speakers are bilingual. This has led to frequent code-switching and the emergence of a mixed language variety sometimes referred to as Bhojpuri-Hindi. For many speakers, Bhojpuri remains the dominant language of the home and informal settings, used for understanding, expression, and inner thought. Hindi, however, is often preferred in formal situations or urban environments, sometimes as a means of showing social status. This dynamic is a central aspect of the language's current context, with some scholars questioning whether it will lead to a new mixed language or the gradual decline of Bhojpuri in certain domains.^[74]

Linguistic Tensions

The close interaction between Bhojpuri and Hindi has sometimes led to linguistic tension and activism. A notable example occurred in the Bhojpuri-speaking areas of Patna in the 1960s with the "**ne-hatao aandolan**" (**remove 'ne' movement**). This movement was a direct reaction against the Hindi grammatical particle *ne* (a marker for the agent in certain past-tense constructions), which is absent in Bhojpuri. Bhojpuri speakers found this particle "unnecessary and revolted against its use,"

organising demonstrations with banners and loudspeakers demanding its removal from Hindi. While the movement was viewed as humorous by some outsiders, it represented a serious assertion of Bhojpuri linguistic identity.^[74]

Grammatical and Lexical Transfers

The influence of Bhojpuri is evident in the Hindi spoken by bilinguals, who often transfer grammatical features and vocabulary from their native tongue. Some common transfers are:

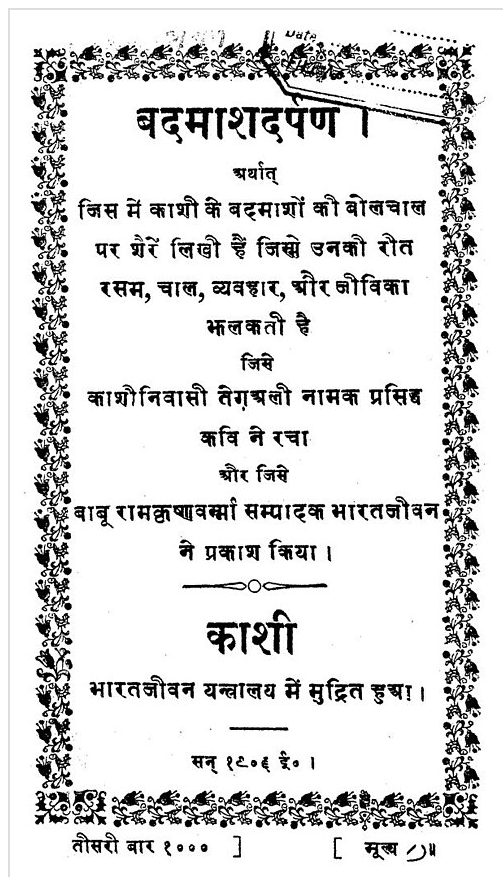
- **Use of the definite noun suffix -wa:** For example, using *laikwa* (the boy) in Hindi instead of the standard Hindi *laṛka*.
- **Substitution of adverbs and interrogatives:** Using Bhojpuri words like *lage* (near) in place of the Hindi *pa:s*.
- **Lexical transfer:** Introducing Bhojpuri words into Hindi, which can sometimes lead to a narrowing of the Hindi word's meaning. For example, using the Bhojpuri word for a mature jack-fruit, *kaTahar*, may lead to the Hindi word being used in a more specific sense.

Literature

Lorikayan, the story of *Veer Lorik* contains Bhojpuri folklore from Eastern Uttar Pradesh.^[75] *Bhikhari Thakur's Bidesiya* is a play, written as a book. *Phool Daliya* is a well-known book by *Prasiddha Narayan Singh*. It comprises poems of *veer ras* (A style of writing) on the theme of *azaadi (Freedom)* about his experiences in the *Quit India movement* and India's struggle with poverty after the country gained independence.

Although Bhojpuri is not one of the established literary languages of India, it has a strong tradition of oral literature.^[76] This "persistent orality" continues in the diaspora, where the language often thrives more through performance, particularly song and music (like folk songs and Chutney), than through formal print literature, adapting across multiple media platforms like radio, recordings, and digital formats.^[33]

The oral traditions of Bhojpuri have been a topic of academic research. In the 20th century, scholars documented and analysed the region's folklore. *W.G. Archer* published collections of folk songs, as did *Durga Shankar Prasad Singh*, whose work was primarily sourced from women in the *Shahabad district*. Other researchers like *Satya Vrata Sinha* focused on the academic classification of folktales. Thematic analysis was also conducted; for instance, *V.S. Gautam* wrote about the role of folk songs such as *Bidesiya* in the development of national consciousness during the colonial period.^[36]



Cover page of *Badmash Darpan* by *Teg Ali Teg*

Media

The first journal to be published in Bhojpuri was *Bagsar Samāchar* which was published in 1915, but was closed in 1918.^[77] The first Bhojpuri weekly was published on 15 August 1947. Bhojpuri journalism rose massively in the 1960s and 1970s. Prominent publications from this era include *Anjor*, published by the *Bhojpuri Parivar* organisation in Patna, and journals from *Bhojpuri Mandal* (Motihari) and *Bhojpuri Samaj* (Arrah). Another important folkloric journal was *Purvaiya* from Varanasi.^[78] Many Bhojpuri magazines and papers are published in Bihar, Jharkhand, and Uttar Pradesh. Several Bhojpuri newspapers are available locally in northern India. *Parichhan* is a contemporary literary-cultural Maithili-Bhojpuri magazine, published by a Maithili-Bhojpuri academy and the government of Delhi, and edited by Parichay Das. *The Sunday Indian, Bhojpuri*^[79] is a regular national news magazine in Bhojpuri. *Aakhar* is a monthly online Bhojpuri literature magazine.^[80] Other media in Bhojpuri include *Lok Lucknow*,^[81] and the channels Mahuaa TV and Hamar TV. Bhojpuri Wikipedia was launched in 2003.^[82] On 22 May 2022, Google Translate added Bhojpuri as one of their languages.^[73]

Vocabulary

Bhojpuri vocabularies have similarity with other Indo Aryan languages and also have loanwords from Persian. Tiwari has classified the words of Bhojpuri in to 6 parts:^[83]

- Words of Sanskrit origin
- Words with untraceable origin
- Words borrowed from other Indo-Aryan Languages
- Sanskrit words either in original or modified form
- Words of non-Aryan Indian origin
- Foreign origin (Arabic, British etc.)

Words of Persian origin are roughly classified under the following head:^[84]

- Words pertaining to kingly states: amīr, kābū, hajūr
- Words relating to Revenue, Administration and Law: darogā, hak, huliya
- Words relating to Islam: Allāh, tobā, mahjid
- Words of intellectual culture, music, education: ilīm, ijjat, munsī
- Words of material culture: kāgaj, kismis, sāl

Since Bengal has been one of the greatest centre for Bhojpuri-speaking people, Bhojpuri has taken a number of words from Bengali. It is also probable that words of European origin came to Bhojpuri through Bengali.^[85] The specific vocabulary of South African Bhojpuri also reflects contact with other languages prevalent in the region, notably incorporating loanwords from Zulu and the pidgin Fanagalo, alongside English.^[10]

Weekdays

English	Bhojpuri (Latin script)	भोजपुरी (देवनागरी लिखाई)
Sunday	<i>Eitwaar</i>	एतवार
Monday	<i>Somaar</i>	सोमार
Tuesday	<i>Mangar</i>	मंगर
Wednesday	<i>Budhh</i>	बुध
Thursday	<i>Biphey</i>	बियफे
Friday	<i>Shuk</i>	शुक
Saturday	<i>Sanichar</i>	सनिचर

Common phrases

English	Bhojpuri		
Hello	<i>Raam</i> राम <i>Parnaam</i> परनाम	<i>Raam</i> राम	/
Welcome/Please come in	<i>Aain</i> आई	<i>na</i> ना	
How are you?	<i>Ka</i> का / /	<i>haal</i> हाल <i>Kaisan</i> कइसन	<i>ba?</i> बा? <i>hava?</i> हवऽ?
I'm good. And you? / We're good. And you	<i>Hum</i> हम <i>Aur</i> अउर <i>Humni</i> हमनी <i>Aur</i> अउर	<i>theek</i> ठीक <i>rauwa?</i> रउवा? <i>theek</i> ठीक <i>aap?</i> आप?	<i>baani.</i> बानी। / / <i>hañi.</i> हई।
What is your name?	<i>Tohaar</i> तोहार <i>ha?</i> ह? <i>naav</i> नाँव	<i>naav</i> नाँव / / <i>ka</i> का	<i>ka</i> का <i>Raur</i> राउर <i>ha?</i> ह?
My name is ...	<i>Hamar</i> हमार <i>ha</i> ह	<i>naav</i> नाँव	
What's up?	<i>Kaa</i> का	<i>howat</i> होवत	<i>aa?</i> आ?
I love you	<i>Hum</i>	<i>tohse</i>	<i>pyaar</i>

हम	तोहसे	प्यार
<i>kareni</i>	/	<i>Hum</i>
करेनी	/	हम
<i>tohra</i>	<i>se</i>	<i>pyaar</i>
तोहरा	से	प्यार
<i>kareni</i>		
करेनी		

Number

English	Bhojpuri
1= one	१= <i>ek</i> = एक
2= two	२= <i>du</i> = दु
3= three	३= <i>teen</i> =तीन
4= four	४= <i>char</i> = चार
5= five	५= <i>pan</i> = पान
6= six	६= <i>chhav</i> = छव
7= seven	७= <i>sat</i> = सात
8= eight	८= <i>aath</i> = आठ
9= nine	९= <i>nav</i> = नव
10= ten	१०= <i>das</i> = दस
100= one hundred	१००= <i>ek say</i> = एक सव
500= five hundred	५००= <i>pan say</i> = पान सव
1000= one thousand	१०००= <i>ek hajar</i> = एक हजार

Words of English origin

- atharāiṭis (अथराइटीस/अथराइटीस): From Arthritis.^[86]
- afkaran (अफ़क़रान/अफ़करन): Used in *South African Bhojpuri*, Borrowed from English phrase "Half a Crown".^[86]
- askūṭara (अस्कूटर/अस्कूटर): From Scooter.^[87]
- asaṭāṭ (असटाट/असटाट): From English verb **Start**. *ṣṭāṭ* is used in South African Bhojpuri. It was borrowed in sense of starting a Motor vehicle or any other mechanical device.^[87]
- aspatāla (अस्पताल/अस्पताल): From Hospital.^[87]

- injin (इन्जिन/इन्जिन): From Engine.^[87]
- eroplana (एरोप्लेन/एरोप्लेन): From Aeroplane.^[87]
- kār (कार/कार): From English Car. *khār* is used in South African Bhojpuri.
- ṭībī (टीबी/टीबी): From T.B., the short form of Tuberculosis.^[87]
- ṭeksī (टेक्सी/टेक्सी): From Taxi.^[87]
- ṭesan (टेसन/टेसन): from English Station.^[87]
- ḍākṭar (डाक्टर/डाक्टर): From Doctor. In South African Bhojpuri *ḍokṭar* or *ḍokṭe* is used.^[87]
- nars (नर्स/नर्स): From Nurse. *nes* or *staf-nes* (Staff Nurse) in South African Bhojpuri.^[87]
- peṭarol (पेट्रोल/पेट्रोल): From Petrol.^[87]
- palaga (पलग/पलग): From Plug.^[87]
- baetrī (बैटरी/बैटरी): From Battery.^[87]
- ba's (बस/बस): From Bus. *baz* in South African Bhojpuri.^[87]
- bhaena (भेन/भेन): From Van. *ven* is used in South African Bhojpuri.^[87]
- moṭar (मोटर/मोटर): From English word Motor, also used for Motor vehicle.^[87]
- rēl (रेल/रेल): from English ***rail***, meaning Train.^[87]
- rēl-gārī (रेलगाड़ी/रेलगाड़ी): *gārī* is a Bhojpuri word meaning Vehicle.
- laurī (लौरी/लौरी): From English word Lorry. *Lori* is used in South African Bhojpuri.^[87]
- sāikīl (साइकिल/साइकिल): From bicycle.^[87]
- sīka (सीक/सीक): From sick. Used in South African Bhojpuri, with the verbal form *sīkā gae* (has become sick).^[87]
- sūgar (सूगर/सूगर): From sugar, meaning Diabetes.^[87]

- hāt (हाट/हाट): From Heart, it used for any heart related disease.^[87]

Example text

The following is Article 1 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights in four languages:

- Bhojpuri (kaithi) – अनुच्छेद १: सवहि ठोकानि आजादे मन्नेठा आउती ओपिनियो के वीएवी सम्मान आओती अधिकारी प्राप्त हवे । ओपिनियो के पास समझ-बूझ आउती अन्तःकरण के स्वर होखता आओती हुनको के दोसरा के साथ भाईयाने के वेवहाल करे के होयता ॥
- Bhojpuri (Devanagari) – अनुच्छेद १: सबहि लोकनि स्वतंत्रे जन्मेलन अउर ओखिनियहूँ के समान सम्मान अउरी अधिकार प्राप्त हवे। ओखिनियो के पास समझ-बूझ अ अंतःकरण के स्वर होखता आओर हुनके हुँ के दोसरा के साथ भ्रातृत्व के बेवहार करय के चाही।^[88]
- Sarnāmi Hindustani (a dialect of Caribbean Hindustani) – *Aadhiaai 1: Sab djanne aadjādi aur barabar paidaa bhailèn, iddjat aur hak mê. Ohi djanne ke lage sab ke samadj-boedj aur hierdaai hai aur doesare se sab soemmat sè, djaane-maane ke chaahin.*^[89]

See also

- Culture of Bhojpuri Region
- Bhojpuri cinema



Footnotes

References

1. "Census of India 2011" (https://censusindia.gov.in/nada/index.php/catalog/42458/download/46089/C-16_25062018.pdf) (PDF). *Office of the Registrar General & Census Commissioner, India*. 2011. p. 8. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20230824120826/https://censusindia.gov.in/nada/index.php/catalog/42458/download/46089/C-16_25062018.pdf) (PDF) from the original on 24 August 2023. Retrieved 22 September 2024.
2. "National Population and Housing Census 2011" (<https://cbs.gov.np/wp-content/uploads/2020/07/National-Population-and-Housing-Census-2011-Caste-ethnicity-and-mother-tongue.pdf>) (PDF). *Census of Nepal*. 2011. p. 138. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20240923053412/https://cbs.gov.np/wp-content/uploads/2020/07/National-Population-and-Housing-Census-2011-Caste-ethnicity-and-mother-tongue.pdf>) (PDF) from the original on 23 September 2024. Retrieved 22 September 2024.
3. Oozeerally, Shameem (March 2013). "The Evolution of Mauritian Bhojpuri: an Ecological Analysis - Mauritius Institute of Education" (<https://www.researchgate.net/publication/323772628>). Retrieved 1 September 2020. {{cite journal}}: Cite journal requires |journal= (help)

4. Rambilass, B. "NAITALI - SOUTH AFRICAN BHOJPURI" (<http://www.indiandiasporacouncil.org/pdf/NAITALI-SOUTH-AFRICAN-BHOJPURI-by-B-Rambilass.pdf>) (PDF). *indiandiasporacouncil.org*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20200918190623/http://www.indiandiasporacouncil.org/pdf/NAITALI-SOUTH-AFRICAN-BHOJPURI-by-B-Rambilass.pdf>) (PDF) from the original on 18 September 2020. Retrieved 1 September 2020.
5. Sudhir Kumar Mishra (22 March 2018). "Bhojpuri, 3 more to get official tag" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20180322204611/https://www.telegraphindia.com/states/jharkhand/bhojpuri-3-more-to-get-official-tag-217369>). *The Telegraph*. Archived from the original (<https://www.telegraphindia.com/states/jharkhand/bhojpuri-3-more-to-get-official-tag-217369>) on 22 March 2018.
6. "New chairman of Bhojpuri Academy | Patna News - Times of India" (<https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/city/patna/new-chairman-of-bhojpuri-academy/articleshow/6447482.cms>). *The Times of India*. 28 August 2010. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20230409203454/https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/city/patna/new-chairman-of-bhojpuri-academy/articleshow/6447482.cms>) from the original on 9 April 2023. Retrieved 21 April 2024.
7. "Bhojpuri entry, Oxford Dictionaries" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20151208140012/http://www.oxforddictionaries.com/us/definition/english/bhojpuri>). *Oxford University Press*. Archived from the original (<http://www.oxforddictionaries.com/us/definition/english/bhojpuri>) on 8 December 2015.
8. Bhojpuri Ethnologue World Languages (2009)
9. Ojha, Atul Kr (6 May 2019), *English-Bhojpuri SMT System: Insights from the Karaka Model*, arXiv:1905.02239 (<https://arxiv.org/abs/1905.02239>)
10. Rajend Mesthrie, *Language in indenture: a sociolinguistic history of Bhojpuri-Hindi in South Africa*, Routledge, 1992, ISBN 978-0415064040, pages 30–32
11. Mesthrie, Rajend (1985). *A History of the Bhojpuri (or "Hindi") Language in South Africa* (<https://books.google.com/books?id=ikdPmwEACAAJ>). University of Cape Town.
12. Hindustani, Caribbean (<http://www.ethnologue.com/language/hns>) Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20160113152633/http://www.ethnologue.com/language/hns>) 13 January 2016 at the Wayback Machine Ethnologue (2013)
13. "Mauritius Bhojpuri" (<https://www.mgirti.ac.mu/index.php/school-of-mauritian-and-area-studies/departement-of-bhojpuri-folklore-oral-traditions>).
14. "Bhojpuri" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20250119111443/https://en.wal.unesco.org/languages/bhojpuri>). Archived from the original (<https://en.wal.unesco.org/languages/bhojpuri>) on 19 January 2025. Retrieved 12 October 2024.
15. *A Translation of the Sëir Mutaqherin*. 1789.
16. *Journal of Asiatic Society of Bengal*. 1871. pp. 111–129.
17. Rennel, James (1781). *Bengal Atlas*.
18. Irvine, William (1903). *The Army of the Indian Moghuls*. London. pp. 168–169.
19. Tiwari, Udai Narayan. *The Origin and Development of Bhojpuri*. Kolkata: The Asiatic society.
20. Hua, Z.; Seedhouse, P.; Cook, V.; Wei, L. (31 July 2007). *Language Learning and Teaching as Social Inter-action* (<https://books.google.com/books?id=cliHDAAQBAJ&dq=bhojpuri+in+fiji&pg=PA202>). Springer. ISBN 978-0-230-59124-0.
21. Verma, Manindra K. (2003), Bhojpuri, In Cardona et al. (Editors), *The Indo-Aryan Languages*, 515–537. London: Routledge
22. Tiwari, Arjun (2014). *Bhojpuri Sāhitya ke itihāsa*. Varanasi: Vishwavidyala Prakashan. p. 35.
23. Cowell, Edward Byles (1897). *The Harsa-carita of Bana*. London: Royal Asiatic Society. p. 32.
24. Tiwari, Arjun. *Bhojpuri Sahtiya Ke Itihas*.
25. Pandey, Narmadeshwar Sahay. *Comprehensive History of Bihar (Bhojpuri Language and literature of Bihar)*.

26. Jain, Danesh; Cardona, George (26 July 2007). *The Indo-Aryan Languages* (<https://books.google.com/books?id=iUHfBQAAQBAJ>). Routledge. p. 569. ISBN 978-1-135-79710-2. "Some scholar enthusiasts like to trace the literary history of Bhojpuri from Siddha Sahitya itself, as early as 8th century A.D. (Upadhyay 1972:39). The so-called Bhojpuri forms that they may find that early may be nothing more than common developments shared by the whole northern complex of language-dialects stretching from the Midlands to the East."
27. Prasad, Vishwanatha. *Yathopaari*.
28. Pandey 1986, p. 41-42.
29. Pandey 1986, p. 57-61.
30. Pandey 1986, p. 105.
31. "The legacy of Indian migration to European colonies" (<https://www.economist.com/news/international/21727896-century-after-india-ended-system-indentured-labour-its-diaspora-building>). *The Economist*. 2 September 2017. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20170901212224/https://www.economist.com/news/international/21727896-century-after-india-ended-system-indentured-labour-its-diaspora-building>) from the original on 1 September 2017. Retrieved 2 September 2017.
32. "Indian Arrival Day" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20170212091036/https://www.nalis.gov.tt/Resources/Subject-Guide/Indian-Arrival-Day>). *www.nalis.gov.tt*. Archived from the original (<https://www.nalis.gov.tt/Resources/Subject-Guide/Indian-Arrival-Day>) on 12 February 2017. Retrieved 29 May 2020.
33. Marzagora, Sara (ed.). *ORAL LITERARY WORLDS (Chapter 4)*. pp. 145–165.
34. Olga van der Klooster & Michel Bakker, *Architectuur en bouwcultuur in Suriname* (2009). KIT Publishers. ISBN 978-90-6832-531-7. Blz. 329-330.
35. Pandey 1986, p. 101-111.
36. Vidyarthi, Lalita Prasad (1978). *Rise of Anthropology in India: A Social Science Orientation* (<https://books.google.com/books?id=c3TqmBoQnf4C&dq=%22bhojpuri%22&pg=PA375>). Concept Publishing Company.
37. Gambhir, Surendra K. (1983). "Diglossia in Dying Languages: A Case Study of Guyanese Bhojpuri and Standard Hindi" (<https://www.jstor.org/stable/30027654>). *Anthropological Linguistics*. **25** (1): 28–38. ISSN 0003-5483 (<https://search.worldcat.org/issn/0003-5483>). JSTOR 30027654 (<https://www.jstor.org/stable/30027654>). Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20240414065416/https://www.jstor.org/stable/30027654>) from the original on 14 April 2024. Retrieved 12 October 2024.
38. Jain, Dinesh (2007). *The Indo-Aryan Languages*. Routledge. ISBN 978-1135797102.
39. Bhojpuri (<http://www.lmp.ucla.edu/Profile.aspx?menu=004&LangID=133>) Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20140225194746/http://www.lmp.ucla.edu/Profile.aspx?menu=004&LangID=133>) 25 February 2014 at the Wayback Machine Language Materials Project, University of California, Los Angeles, United States
40. "Forced Labour" (<http://www.nationalarchives.gov.uk/pathways/blackhistory/india/forced.htm>). The National Archives, Government of the United Kingdom. 2010. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20161204015712/http://www.nationalarchives.gov.uk/pathways/blackhistory/india/forced.htm>) from the original on 4 December 2016.
41. Dept, West Bengal (India) Information and Public Relations (1976). *Introducing West Bengal* (<https://books.google.com/books?id=JITKDDK11M4C&q=Bhojpuri+and+Bengali>). Department of Information and Public Relations, Government of West Bengal.
42. Tuṅga, Sudhāṃśu Śekhara (1995). *Bengali and Other Related Dialects of South Assam* (<https://books.google.com/books?id=IRRYBHQvXdsC&q=Bhojpuri+and+Bengali&pg=PA79>). Mittal Publications. ISBN 978-81-7099-588-3.
43. Pandey, Shruti (2003). *A Comparative Study of Bhojpuri and Bengali* (<https://books.google.com/books?id=Z35jAAAAMAAJ&q=Similar>). Vishwavidyalaya Prakashan. p. 122. ISBN 978-81-7124-343-3.
44. Other proposed methods to represent the drawled "a" sound are, देख'ल', देखःलः and देखअलअ.

45. Grierson, G.A. (1902). *Linguistic Survey of India. Vol V. Part II.*
46. Varmā, Śīlā (1985). *The Structure of the Magahi Verb* (<https://books.google.com/books?id=qndjAAAMAAJ&q=Bhojpuri+magahi+Maithili>). Manohar. p. 6.
47. *International Journal of Dravidian Linguistics: IJDL* (<https://books.google.com/books?id=l34LAQAAMAAJ&q=western+Magadhan>). Department of Linguistics, University of Kerala. 2008.
48. *The New Encyclopædia Britannica* (<https://books.google.com/books?id=O1RbjdP6nrgC&q=western+Magadhan>). Encyclopædia Britannica. 1983. ISBN 978-0-85229-400-0.
49. *The History and Culture of the Indian People* (<https://books.google.com/books?id=0yAKAQAAIAAJ&q=western+Magadhan>). G. Allen & Unwin. 1951. p. 358.
50. Study, Indian Institute of Advanced (1969). *Transactions* (https://books.google.com/books?id=c_M7AQAAIAAJ&q='bate'). R. Nivas.
51. *Bihar in Folklore Study: An Anthology* (<https://books.google.com/books?id=SBzaAAAAMAAJ&q=bate+>). Indian Publications. 1971.
52. Parable of the prodigal son in Benares Bhojpuri (<https://dsal.uchicago.edu/lsi/6968AK>) Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20160304101536/http://dsal.uchicago.edu/lsi/6968AK>) 4 March 2016 at the Wayback Machine, A Recording in May 1920 by Rajaji Gupta, Linguistic Survey of India, Digital South Asia Library, University of Chicago, USA
53. Parable of the prodigal son in Nagpuria Bhojpuri (<https://dsal.uchicago.edu/lsi/6588AK>) Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20160304210005/http://dsal.uchicago.edu/lsi/6588AK>) 4 March 2016 at the Wayback Machine, A Recording in 1920 by Shiva Sahay Lal, Linguistic Survey of India, Digital South Asia Library, University of Chicago, USA
54. Shaligram Shukla (1981), Bhojpuri Grammar, Georgetown University School of Language, ISBN 978-0878401895
55. Cardona, George; Jain, Dhanesh K. (26 July 2007). *The Indo-Aryan Languages* (<https://books.google.com/books?id=OtCPAgAAQBAJ&dq=Mirzapur+district+Bhojpuri+language&pg=PA518>). Routledge. ISBN 978-1-135-79711-9.
56. Monika Horstmann (1969), Sadari, Indologia Berolinensis, Otto Harrassowitz – Wiesbaden, Germany, pp 176–180
57. Thiel-Horstmann, M. (1969). "Sadani : a Bhojpuri dialect spoken in Chotanagpur". S2CID 127410862 (<https://api.semanticscholar.org/CorpusID:127410862>). {{cite journal}}: Cite journal requires |journal= (help)
58. Michaelis, Susanne (2008). *Roots of Creole Structures: Weighing the Contribution of Substrates and Superstrates* (<https://books.google.com/books?id=pPUeQLcGMOMC&dq=%22bhojpuri%22&pg=PA174>). John Benjamins Publishing. ISBN 978-90-272-5255-5.
59. Trammell, Robert L. (1971). "The Phonology of the Northern Standard Dialect of Bhojpuri". *Anthropological Linguistics*. **13** (4): 126–141. JSTOR 30029290 (<https://www.jstor.org/stable/30029290>).
60. Thakur, Gopal (2020). *A Grammar of Bhojpuri*. p. 82.
61. Diwakar Mishra and Kalika Bali, A COMPARATIVE PHONOLOGICAL STUDY OF THE DIALECTS OF HINDI (<http://www.icphs2011.hk/resources/OnlineProceedings/RegularSession/Mishra/Mishra.pdf>) Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20140201170926/http://www.icphs2011.hk/resources/OnlineProceedings/RegularSession/Mishra/Mishra.pdf>) 1 February 2014 at the Wayback Machine, ICPhS XVII, Hong Kong, 17–21 August 2011, pp 1390
62. Diwakar Mishra and Kalika Bali, A COMPARATIVE PHONOLOGICAL STUDY OF THE DIALECTS OF HINDI (<http://www.icphs2011.hk/resources/OnlineProceedings/RegularSession/Mishra/Mishra.pdf>) Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20140201170926/http://www.icphs2011.hk/resources/OnlineProceedings/RegularSession/Mishra/Mishra.pdf>) 1 February 2014 at the Wayback Machine, ICPhS XVII, Hong Kong, 17–21 August 2011, pp 1390–1393
63. Shukla, Shaligram (1981), Bhojpuri Grammar, Washington, D. C., Georgetown University Press

64. Yadav, Arun Kumar; Kumar, Abhishek; Kumar, Mohit; Yadav, Divakar (4 July 2024). "Semantic proximity assessment in Bhojpuri and Maithili: a word embedding perspective" (<https://doi.org/10.1007/s13278-024-01287-w>). *Social Network Analysis and Mining*. **14** (1): 130. doi:10.1007/s13278-024-01287-w (<https://doi.org/10.1007/s13278-024-01287-w>). ISSN 1869-5469 (<https://search.worldcat.org/issn/1869-5469>).
65. Jain, Dinesh; Cardona, George (2007). *The Indo-Aryan Languages*. Routledge. ISBN 9781135797119.
66. Sarita Boodho, *Bhojpuri traditions in Mauritius*, Mauritius Bhojpuri Institute, 1999, ISBN 978-9990390216, pages 47–48 and 85–92
67. "Chidambaram speaks a surprise" (<http://www.thehindu.com/news/national/article3429620.ece>). Chennai, India. The Hindu. 17 May 2012. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20120520172134/http://www.thehindu.com/news/national/article3429620.ece>) from the original on 20 May 2012. Retrieved 5 June 2012.
68. "Jharkhand gives second language status to Magahi, Angika, Bhojpuri and Maithili" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20190328090028/https://www.avenuemail.in/ranchi/jharkhand-gives-second-language-status-to-magahi-angika-bhojpuri-and-maithili/118291/>). *Avenue Mail*. 21 March 2018. Archived from the original (<https://www.avenuemail.in/ranchi/jharkhand-gives-second-language-status-to-magahi-angika-bhojpuri-and-maithili/118291/>) on 28 March 2019. Retrieved 17 December 2019.
69. "Bhojpuri" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20191217170106/https://vksu.ac.in/new/bhojpuri/>). Archived from the original (<https://vksu.ac.in/new/bhojpuri/>) on 17 December 2019. Retrieved 17 December 2019.
70. "Banaras Hindu University, Faculty of Arts, bhojpuri addhyan kendra Varanasi" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20140718084839/http://bhu.ac.in/arts/bhojpuri/pc.php>). *www.bhu.ac.in*. Archived from the original (<http://www.bhu.ac.in/arts/bhojpuri/pc.php>) on 18 July 2014. Retrieved 17 December 2019.
71. "Bhojpuri in NOU" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20200228073002/http://www.nalandaopenuniversity.com/notices/Schools/school%20of%20language/content%20for%20website%20for%20Certificate%20course%20in%20Bhojpuri.pdf>) (PDF). Archived from the original (<http://www.nalandaopenuniversity.com/notices/Schools/school%20of%20language/content%20for%20website%20for%20Certificate%20course%20in%20Bhojpuri.pdf>) (PDF) on 28 February 2020. Retrieved 17 December 2019.
72. "Archived copy" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20170516181428/http://dsmru.up.nic.in/User/course.aspx>). Archived from the original (<https://dsmru.up.nic.in/User/course.aspx>) on 16 May 2017. Retrieved 6 June 2019.
73. "Google Translate now supports Sanskrit and Bhojpuri" (<https://www.indiatoday.in/technology/news/story/google-translate-gets-24-new-languages-including-assamese-bhojpuri-sanskrit-1948298-2022-05-11>). 11 May 2022. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20221103095819/https://www.indiatoday.in/technology/news/story/google-translate-gets-24-new-languages-including-assamese-bhojpuri-sanskrit-1948298-2022-05-11>) from the original on 3 November 2022. Retrieved 3 November 2022.
74. Alatis, James E.; Tan, Ai-Hui (7 September 2001). *Georgetown University Round Table on Languages and Linguistics (GURT) 1999: Language in Our Time: Bilingual Education and Official English, Ebonics and Standard English, Immigration and the Unz Initiative* (https://books.google.com/books?id=IjumbfV_7y0C&dq=%22bhojpuri%22&pg=PA319). Georgetown University Press. ISBN 978-1-58901-854-9.
75. Auty, Robert (4 December 1969). *Traditions of heroic and epic poetry* (<https://books.google.com/books?id=75e5RRqIhMQC&q=lorik+ahir&pg=PA8>). ISBN 9780900547720. Retrieved 27 February 2014.
76. "Bhojpuri" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20230129164832/https://www.mustgo.com/worldlanguages/bhojpuri/?amp>). Archived from the original (<https://www.mustgo.com/>) on 29 January 2023. Retrieved 30 August 2023.

77. *Journal of Historical Research* (<https://books.google.com/books?id=7qZQAQAAMAAJ&q=bagsar+samachar+bhojpuri+1915>). Department of History, Ranchi University. 2004. p. 91. "The first quarterly in Bhojpuri Bagsar Samachar came up in 1915 but was closed down in 1918"
78. Yadav, Minakshi (2023). "Debunking the Myth of the Standard: Development of Hindi in Bihar". *International Journal of English and Studies*. **5** (1): 10.
79. "Today Bhojpuri Newspaper Update Headlines India- The Sunday Indian Online Magazine – The Sunday Indian" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20140130031143/http://www.thesundayindian.com/bh/>). *www.thesundayindian.com*. Archived from the original (<http://www.thesundayindian.com/bh/>) on 30 January 2014. Retrieved 17 December 2019.
80. "आखर भोजपुरी पत्रिका Aakhar Bhojpuri Magazine" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20160305153456/http://www.aakhar.com/>). Archived from the original (<http://www.aakhar.com/>) on 5 March 2016. Retrieved 13 March 2016.
81. "Archived copy" (https://web.archive.org/web/20150225130153/http://rni.nic.in/display_language.asp). Archived from the original (https://rni.nic.in/display_language.asp) on 25 February 2015. Retrieved 10 December 2009.
82. *A Study on the Usage of Internet by Working Women of Vadodara City for Performing Their Household Responsibilities*. Anchor Academic Publishing. 2016. ISBN 978-3960675518.
83. Tiwari 1960, p. xlv.
84. Tiwari 1960, p. xlv.
85. Tiwari 1960, p. xlv.
86. Dalby, Andrew (28 October 2015). *Dictionary of Languages: The definitive reference to more than 400 languages* (<https://books.google.com/books?id=7dHNCgAAQBAJ&dq=%22bhojpuri%22+%22word%22+%22english%22+%22loanword%22&pg=PA91>). Bloomsbury Publishing. ISBN 978-1-4081-0214-5.
87. Barz, Richard Keith; Siegel, Jeff (1988). *Language Transplanted: The Development of Overseas Hindi* (<https://books.google.com/books?id=IMns1oU3n14C&dq=%22bhojpuri%22+%22word%22+%22english%22+%22loanword%22&pg=PA162>). Otto Harrassowitz Verlag. ISBN 978-3-447-02872-1.
88. "Universal Declaration of Human Rights – Bhojpuri" (https://www.ohchr.org/EN/UDHR/Documents/UDHR_Translations/bhj.pdf) (PDF). *United Nations* (in Bhojpuri). 23 April 2019. p. 1. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20200103114805/https://www.ohchr.org/EN/UDHR/Documents/UDHR_Translations/bhj.pdf) (PDF) from the original on 3 January 2020. Retrieved 3 January 2020.
89. "Universal Declaration of Human Rights – Sarnāmi Hindustani" (https://www.ohchr.org/EN/UDHR/Documents/UDHR_Translations/hns.pdf) (PDF). *United Nations*. (in Sarnāmi Hindustani). 9 December 2013. p. 2. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20200103114804/https://www.ohchr.org/EN/UDHR/Documents/UDHR_Translations/hns.pdf) (PDF) from the original on 3 January 2020. Retrieved 3 January 2020.

Bibliography

- Rajathi, J; Perumalsamy, P (2021). "Bhojpuri" in *Linguistic Survey of India Bihar Volume* (http://lsi.gov.in/MTSI_app/DraftReport/Bihar/9.%20BHOJPURI.pdf), New Delhi: Office of the Registrar General. pp. 293–407.
- Pandey, Rasbihari (1986). *Bhōpurī Bhāshā kā itihāsa* (in Hindi) (1st ed.). Arrah: Lok Sahitya Sangam.
- Tiwari, Uday Narayan (1960). *The Origin And Development Of Bhojpuri*. The Asiatic Society.

Further reading

- Shukla, Shaligram (1981). *Bhojpuri Grammar*. Georgetown University Press. ISBN 9780878401895.
- Lohar, Gopal Thakur (4 June 2006). *A Sociolinguistic Survey of the Bhojpuri Language in Nepal* (<https://archive.org/details/a-sociolinguistic-survey-of-bhojpuri-by-gopal-thakur>) (Masters). Kirtipur, Kathmandu, Nepal: Central Department of Linguistics, Tribhuvan University.
- Ghosh, Aditi (2012). "Bhojpuri as a non-dominant variety of Hindi". In: Muhr, Rudolf et al (eds.). *Non-Dominant Varieties of Pluricentric Languages. Getting the Picture. In Memory of Michael Clyne*, hrsg. v. Rudolf Muhr (Österreichisches Deutsch - Sprache der Gegenwart 14). Frankfurt am Main, Berlin, Bern, Bruxelles: Peter Lang, 2012. pp. 435–452.
- Lohar, Gopal Thakur (2020). *A Grammar of Bhojpuri* (<https://www.academia.edu/45566555>) (PhD). Kathmandu, Nepal: Faculty of Humanities and Social Sciences, Tribhuvan University.

On Diasporic Bhojpuri

- Gambhir, Surendra K. (1983). "Diglossia in Dying Languages: A Case Study of Guyanese Bhojpuri and Standard Hindi". *Anthropological Linguistics*. **25** (1): 28–38. JSTOR 30027654 (<https://www.jstor.org/stable/30027654>).
- Mesthrie, Rajend (1993). "Koineization in the Bhojpuri–Hindi diaspora — with special reference to South Africa". *International Journal of the Sociology of Language* (99): 25–44. doi:10.1515/ijsl.1993.99.25 (<https://doi.org/10.1515%2Fijsl.1993.99.25>).
- Mesthrie, Rajend (2020) [1991]. *Language in Indenture: A Sociolinguistic History of Bhojpuri-Hindi in South Africa*. Routledge.
- Jayaram, N. (2000). "The Dynamics of Language in Indian Diaspora: The Case of Bhojpuri/Hindi in Trinidad". *Sociological Bulletin*. **49** (1): 41–62. doi:10.1177/0038022920000103 (<https://doi.org/10.1177%2F0038022920000103>). JSTOR 23619888 (<https://www.jstor.org/stable/23619888>).

External links

- The Universal Declaration of Human Rights in Bhojpuri, United Nations Information Centre, India (1998)
- Archived open-access recordings of Bhojpuri (<https://scholarspace.manoa.hawaii.edu/handle/10125/4250/simple-search?filterquery=Bhojpuri&filtername=language&filtertype>equals>) from Kaipuleohone
- English-Bhojpuri Machine Translation System (<https://arxiv.org/abs/1905.02239>)
- Bhojpuri (http://lsi.gov.in/MTSI_app/DraftReport/Bihar/9.%20BHOJPURI.pdf). Linguistic Survey of India.
- Bhojpuri Language Resource (<https://digital.library.unt.edu/explore/collections/BPLR>) collection of Bhojpuri language documentation in the Computational Resource for South Asian Languages (CoRSAL) archive